



MODULE 4

Feedback and communication

How do you give feedback, and what does the player actually hear?

CORE THEORY

Feedback is the most powerful learning tool in sport. But also the most misused. Research by Hattie & Timperley (2007) shows that effective feedback focuses on the task and learning process, not the person. The SBI model (Situation–Behavior–Impact) provides structure: describe the situation, the specific behavior, and the impact. Positive-corrective feedback (not the sandwich method) is 4-5x more effective than purely critical feedback with youth athletes.

Source: Hattie & Timperley (2007) · Magill (2011) · Amorose (2007) · Kim Scott (2017)

"Feedback is a gift, but only when the recipient experiences it that way."

Sheila Heen

"The problem isn't that people disagree. The problem is that they don't say it honestly."

Kim Scott

SELF-REFLECTION

- 1 What is the ratio of positive to corrective feedback you give during a training? Do you think that's accurate?
- 2 Do you give feedback on the person or on the behavior? Give a recent example of each.
- 3 Which player on your team systematically receives less feedback from you? Why?
- 4 How do you react when a player contradicts or doesn't accept your feedback?
- 5 When did you last ask a player for feedback on your own coaching?

NOTES

**BOOKS**

- **Radical Candor**
Kim Scott
Why: Care personally, challenge directly. The best framework for honest yet respectful feedback. Chapter 3 is gold.
- **Thanks for the Feedback**
Douglas Stone & Sheila Heen
Why: How to give AND receive feedback. Essential for coaches who also want to grow themselves.
- **Nonviolent Communication**
Marshall Rosenberg
Why: Communicating from needs, not blame. Changes how you talk to players and parents.

**VIDEO'S / TED TALKS**

- **How to Give and Receive Feedback**
Sheila Heen (Harvard)
[youtube.com/watch?v=FQNbaKKYk_Q](https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=FQNbaKKYk_Q)
Three types of feedback. Learn which ones you give and which you should be giving.
- **Radical Candor**
Kim Scott (FirstRound Talk)
[youtube.com/watch?v=4yODaLLQ2IM](https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4yODaLLQ2IM)
The 2x2 grid: ruinous empathy vs. obnoxious aggression vs. manipulative insincerity vs. radical candor.

**PODCASTS**

- **Coaching Real Leaders**
HBR Podcast: having difficult feedback conversations
hbr.org/podcasts/coaching-real-leaders
- **Dare to Lead with Brené Brown**
Episode on honest conversations and "clear is kind"
brenebrown.com/podcast

⚡ ACTION THIS WEEK

Give specific SBI feedback to three players this week: "In [situation] you did [behavior], the impact was [effect]." No judgment, no interpretation.

One communication habit I want to change in my coaching:
